

UKRAINE

HUMANITARIAN ACCESS SEVERITY OVERVIEW

As of May 2026

In May 2026, OCHA conducted a humanitarian access severity monitoring exercise to assess humanitarian actors' perceptions of access constraints and their ability to conduct operations across Ukraine. Given the different access dynamics across the country, the exercise used two levels of analysis: hromada-level analysis in conflict-affected front-line and border oblasts, and raion-level analysis in central and western Ukraine.

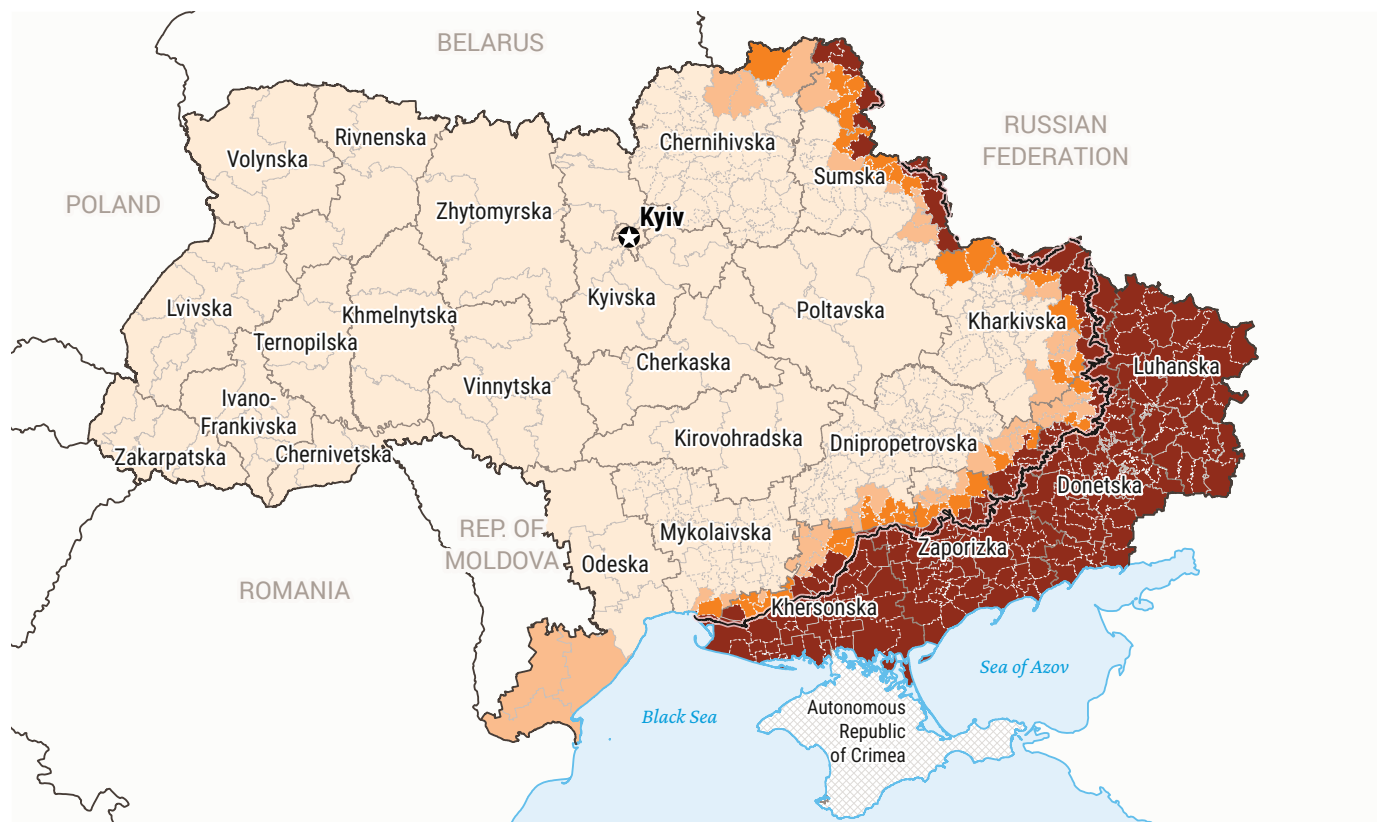
In the 521 conflict-affected hromadas assessed in front-line and border oblasts, 251 hromadas were classified as having high or extremely high access difficulties, up from 242 hromadas in October 2025. The deterioration was most significant at the most severe end of the scale, with hromadas classified as having extremely high access constraints or no access (level 4) increasing from 196 to 211. At the same time, the number of hromadas classified as accessible or having low access constraints (level 1) declined from 243 to 225.

Access deterioration was driven primarily by the proliferation of drones, recurrent attacks affecting humanitarian personnel, assets and facilities, and increasingly constrained operating conditions in border areas. These factors reduced operational predictability and limited humanitarian presence, including in areas where the front line did not shift substantially. Overall, partners reported deterioration in access conditions in 42 hromadas. Of these, 15 hromadas worsened from high access difficulties (level 3) to extremely high access constraints or no access (level 4), mostly in Zaporizka and Khersonska oblasts, where five and four hromadas respectively moved into the most severe category.

The highest concentrations of hromadas with high access difficulties were recorded in areas directly affected by the armed conflict, including areas along the front line or exposed to active hostilities, cross-border attacks, drone activity, mines and unexploded ordnance, and movement restrictions. In these areas, humanitarian operations may still take place, but are often intermittent, highly constrained or dependent on specific windows of access.

Most hromadas assessed as having extremely high access constraints or no access (level 4) were in territories of Ukraine occupied by the Russian Federation. During the exercise, these areas remained inaccessible to humanitarian actors operating from areas under the control of the Government of Ukraine. The access situation for these hromadas was assessed in the most severe category (level 4), with no breakdown by specific type of access impediment.

In central and western Ukraine, 74 raions were assessed. Of these, 71 raions were classified as accessible or having low access constraints (level 1), while three raions, all in Odeska Oblast, were classified as having moderate access constraints (level 2).



LEGEND/ DEFINITIONS

Low access constraints (Level 1):

Frequent checkpoints, airstrikes, and UXOs restrict operations – partners reach only a minority of people in need.

Moderate access constraints (Level 2):

Checkpoints, airstrikes, and UXOs cause regular restrictions, but humanitarian operations continue.

Not assessed

High access constraints (Level 3):

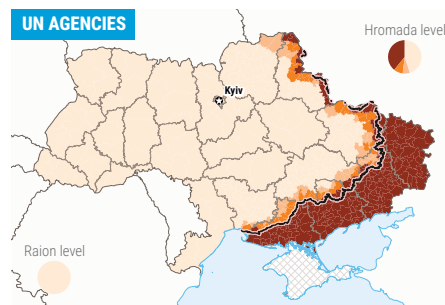
Frequent checkpoints, airstrikes, and UXOs restrict operations. Partners can reach only a minority of people in need.

Extremely high access constraints (Level 4):

Active hostilities or systematic restrictions directly block humanitarian access. Partners cannot reach people in need at scale.

Front line as of 22 April 2026

UN AGENCIES



INTERNATIONAL NGOs



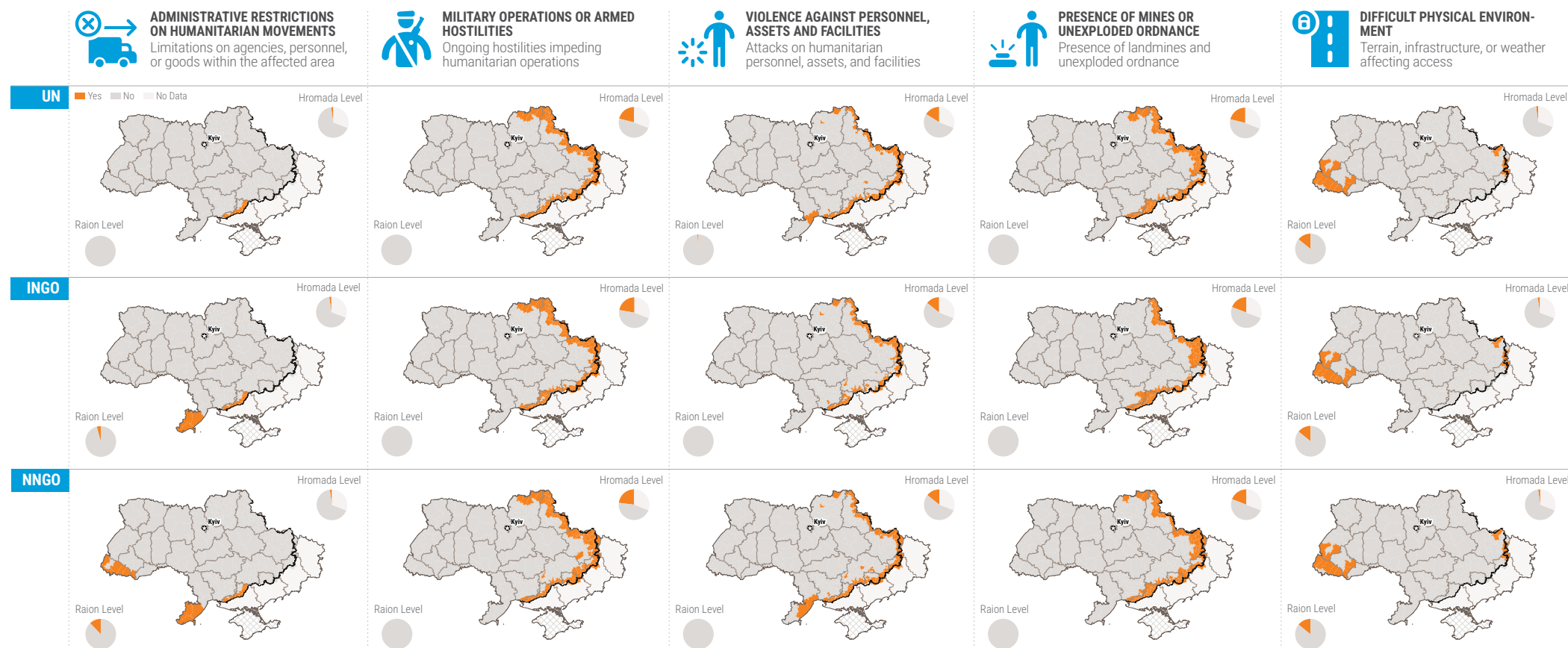
NATIONAL NGOs



UKRAINE

HUMANITARIAN ACCESS CONSTRAINTS BY ORGANIZATION TYPE

As of May 2026



Access constraints varied by type, location, operating modality and organization type, but the overall pattern was consistent across UN agencies, international NGOs and national NGOs. In conflict-affected front-line and border hromadas, the main constraints identified were military operations and ongoing hostilities, violence affecting humanitarian personnel, assets and facilities, and the presence of mines and unexploded ordnance (UXO). **Together, these three categories accounted for 94 per cent of all constraints identified in front-line and border hromadas.**

The similarity of constraint patterns across organization types suggests that access conditions in front-line and border hromadas were shaped primarily by the conflict environment. Access severity was assessed separately, taking into account how the identified constraints affected the ability of humanitarian partners to conduct operations in each location.

Partners' concerns regarding violence affecting humanitarian personnel, assets and facilities, particularly drone-related incidents, are corroborated by incident reports to the Access Monitoring and Reporting Framework. Reported drone-related incidents affecting humanitarian personnel, assets and facilities increased from 25 in the previous reporting period to 36 during the current reporting period, **with their share of total incidents increasing from 35 per cent to 42 per cent.** The impact was particularly acute in Khersonska Oblast, where partners identified drone activity as a critical constraint on humanitarian operations.

Administrative restrictions on the movement of agencies, personnel or goods accounted for a smaller share of constraints identified in front-line and border hromadas. These restrictions were nevertheless significant in specific locations where checkpoint procedures, enhanced screening, local movement requirements or military mobilization-related concerns affected humanitarian missions and staff

movement. At the same time, partners noted that engagement and advocacy with authorities and security services had significantly reduced movement restrictions in Sumska Oblast in 2026, after these had been reported as a significant constraint since late 2024.

In central and western Ukraine, access constraints were less severe and more localized. The main constraints identified were movement constraints linked to mobilization-related documentation requirements, border-area access procedures and staff movement, as well as mines and unexploded ordnance. While these constraints were noted in several locations, the consolidated access severity classification remained low in most raions: only three raions, all in Odeska Oblast, were classified as having moderate access constraints. Similar concerns were reported by national NGOs in six raions in Zakarpatska and Ivano-Frankivska oblasts but did not affect the consolidated access severity classification.

UKRAINE

HUMANITARIAN RESPONSE BY ACCESS SEVERITY

As of May 2026

Between January and May 2026, humanitarian partners reached 1.46 million people in front-line and border oblasts, based on direct reach reporting. Reach was highest in hromadas classified as accessible or having low access constraints (level 1), with 527,000 people reached, or 36 per cent of reported reach. This was followed by hromadas with high access difficulties (level 3), where 482,000 people were directly reached and assisted, or 33 per cent; hromadas with moderate access constraints (level 2), where 368,000 people were reached, or 25 per cent; and hromadas with extremely high access constraints or no access (level 4), where around 80,000 people were reached, or 6 per cent. Reported reach in the most severe access category should be interpreted with caution, given displacement, limited data availability, and the fact that most hromadas in this category are in territories of Ukraine occupied by the Russian Federation.

The scale of direct reach in hromadas with high access difficulties (level 3), nearly as high as in accessible areas and representing one third of all reported reach in assessed front-line and border hromadas, indicates that partners continued to deliver assistance at scale in prioritized areas despite significant constraints. Direct reach in this category was geographically concentrated, with Khersonska and Dnipropetrovska oblasts accounting for 178,000 and 117,000 people reached respectively, or about 61 per cent of all reach in hromadas with high access difficulties. Sumska and Kharkivska oblasts also accounted for significant reach, with 62,000 and 59,000 people reached respectively. These figures should be interpreted alongside differences in population size, partner presence and established programming, which influence absolute reach across areas.

Most hromadas classified as having extremely high access constraints or no access (level 4) are in territories of Ukraine occupied by the Russian Federation and remain inaccessible to humanitarian actors operating from Government-controlled areas. At the same time, reported reach in this category was concentrated in areas of Khersonska, Zaporizka, Dnipropetrovska and Sumska oblasts that remain under the control of the Government of Ukraine but were assessed as having extremely high access constraints or no access due to intensified hostilities and severe operational constraints.

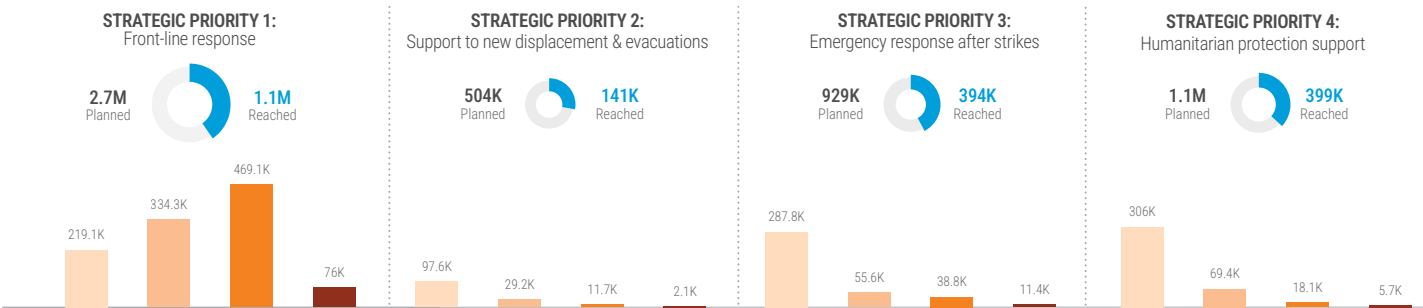
In the 15 hromadas that deteriorated to extremely high access constraints or no access (level 4) between the October 2025 and May 2026 exercises, reported direct reach fell from approximately 92,000 people in January–May 2025 to 8,500 people in January–May 2026, a decline of more than 90 per cent. This reflects the operational impact of intensified hostilities and the narrowing or loss of access in areas where humanitarian response had previously remained possible.

In central and western Ukraine, which are largely accessible and outside the front-line and border oblast total above, partners reported 372,000 people reached.

METHODOLOGY

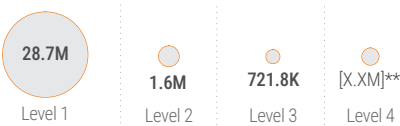
The access severity monitoring exercise was conducted through focus group discussions with humanitarian partners, including UN agencies, international NGOs and national NGOs. It captured partners' perceptions of access constraints and their impact on humanitarian operations. Analysis was conducted at hromada level in conflict-affected front-line and border oblasts, covering all assessed hromadas, and at raion level in central and western Ukraine, covering all raions. Areas in territories of Ukraine occupied by the Russian Federation were included in the analysis and assessed as level 4, as they remained inaccessible to humanitarian actors operating from areas under the control of the Government of Ukraine. Findings reflect partners' reported access perceptions and operational constraints at the time of data collection.

REACH BY ACCESS AND STRATEGIC PRIORITY (January–May 2026)



POPULATION AND REACH BY ACCESS SEVERITY LEVEL* (January–May 2026)

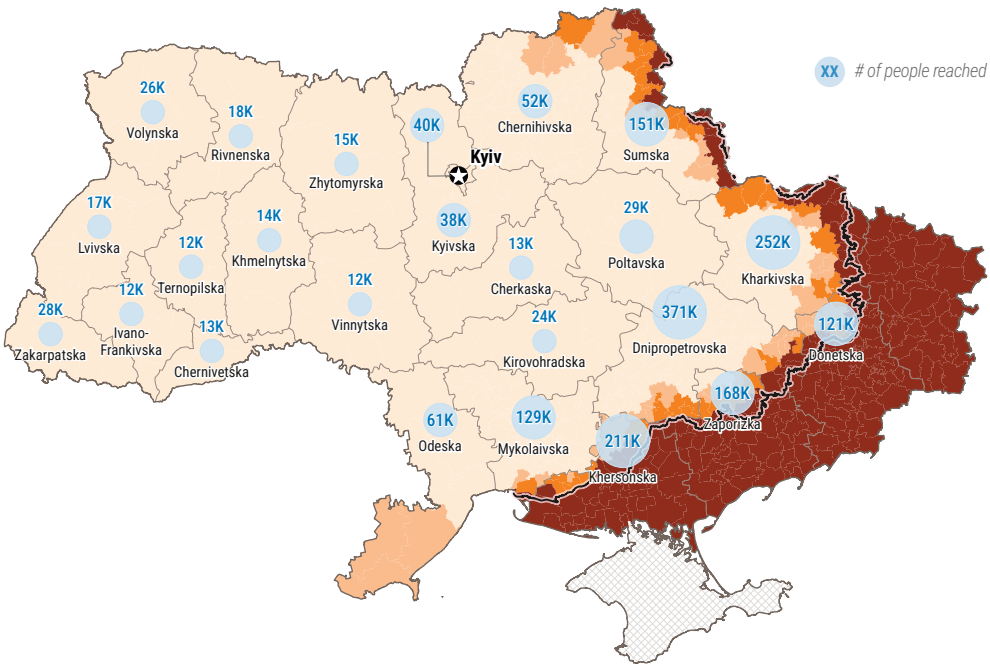
INDICATIVE POPULATION BY ACCESS SEVERITY LEVEL*



* Population estimates are indicative and affected by displacement and limited data availability.

** Figures for level 4 hromadas are not shown, as most are in territories of Ukraine occupied by the Russian Federation and remain inaccessible to humanitarian actors operating from Government-controlled areas.

PEOPLE REACHED BY OBLAST



REACH BY CLUSTER, ACCESS SEVERITY LEVEL

